

Alternative English — 2026

Full Marks: 50 Pass Marks: 17 Time: 2 hours

(The figures in the margin indicate full marks for the questions.)

Allotment of Marks

Group – A (Prose)

Q. No. 1 carries 1 mark each — $1 \times 5 = 5$

Q. No. 2 carries 2 marks each — $2 \times 2 = 4$

Q. No. 3 carries 2 marks each — $3 \times 2 = 6$

Q. No. 4 carries 5 marks — $5 \times 1 = 5$

Total = 20

Group – B (Poetry)

Q. No. 5 carries 1 mark each — $1 \times 5 = 5$

Q. No. 6 carries 2 marks each — $2 \times 2 = 4$

Q. No. 7 carries 5 marks each — $5 \times 1 = 5$

Q. No. 8 carries $\frac{1}{2}$ mark each — $\frac{1}{2} \times 2 = 1$

Total = 15

Group – C (Grammar and Composition)

Q. No. 9 carries 1 mark each — $1 \times 5 = 5$

Q. No. 10 carries 1 mark each — $1 \times 5 = 5$

Q. No. 11 carries 5 marks — $5 \times 1 = 5$

Total = 15

Group – A: Prose (Marks – 20)

1. Give brief answers to any five of the following questions in full sentences: $1 \times 5 = 5$

(a) In which street was Rosemary shopping when she met Miss Smith?

(b) Which Russian author influenced Katherine Mansfield?

(c) What was the name of the airport situated in Guwahati in 1949?

(d) How much was the air fare from Guwahati to Dumdum in 1949?

(e) From where did the new vicar hail?

(f) In the course of how many years did Albert Edward own ten shops?

(g) What is SM Samponio?

2. Answer any two of the following questions: $2 \times 2 = 4$

(a) Who was Miss Smith? Why did Rosemary send her back?

(b) Name the two places associated with Buddhism mentioned by Bhupen Hazarika in 'The Voyage'.

(c) What did Albert Edward do before he became the verger at St. Peter's?

(d) Why did Philip disapprove of Rosemary's decision to keep Miss Smith with them?

3. Give answers to any two of the following questions: $3 \times 2 = 6$

(a) What happened when the wheels of the plane to Calcutta had started rolling?

(b) Present your views on the food and flavours mentioned by Hazarika in '*The Voyage*'?

(c) How did the manager react upon his discovery that Mr. Foreman could neither read nor write?

(d) What kind of relationship do Rosemary and Philip share in '*A Cup of Tea*'?

4. Answer any one of the following questions: $5 \times 1 = 5$

(a) Describe in detail, how Albert Edward lost the job of the verger at St. Peter's.

(b) Comment on the significance of the title of the story '*A Cup of Tea*'.

Group – B: Poetry (Marks – 15)

5. Answer any five of the following questions as directed in full sentences: $1 \times 5 = 5$

(a) What type of poem is '*Ozymandias of Egypt*'?

(b) Who is the poet of the poem '*Strange Meeting*'?

(c) Why does Dickinson describe death as being kind and civil in the poem '*Because I could not stop for Death*'?

(d) What does the speaker discover in the underworld in the poem '*Strange Meeting*'?

(e) Name the collection of poetry in which '*Ozymandias of Egypt*' got first published?

6. Answer briefly any two of the following: $2 \times 2 = 4$

(a) What are Topper and Tulle in the poem '*Because I could not stop for Death*'?

(b) What does the poet mean by '*Titanic Wars*'?

(c) What is the only thing remaining in the vast desert?

(d) Which words are used to describe Death in the poem '*Because I could not stop for Death*'?

(e) Which period of human life is referred to as '*Gazing Grain*' in the poem '*Because I could not stop for Death*'?

7. Answer any one of the following questions: $5 \times 1 = 5$

(a) Bring out the central idea contained in the poem '*Ozymandias of Egypt*'.

(b) Write a brief note on Wilfred Owen's representation of the underworld to explore the horrors of war in

'Strange Meeting'.

8. Write the meanings of the words given below: (Any two) $\frac{1}{2} \times 2 = 1$

(i) Sullen (ii) Wreck (iii) Quivering (iv) Clogged

Group – C: Grammar and Composition (Marks – 15)

9. Add question tags to the following sentences: (Any five) $1 \times 5 = 5$

(a) Nobody came forward to help her, _____?

(b) Let us go for a walk, _____?

(c) She is singing a song, _____?

(d) Any one can become rich, _____?

(e) Please don't smoke here, _____?

(f) There are no vehicles on the road, _____?

(g) We seldom meet now-a-days, _____?

10. Correct the errors in any five of the following sentences and rewrite them: $1 \times 5 = 5$

(a) One of my friend told me so.

(b) She is best player in the team.

(c) He is my cousin brother.

(d) They have arrived a week ago.

(e) Mr. Baruah left India with bag and baggage.

(f) Man is superior than animal.

11. Choose any one of the topics listed below and write a paragraph on it: $5 \times 1 = 5$

(a) Youth: the Nation builder of tomorrow

(b) Flood in Assam

(c) Artificial Intelligence

(d) Global Warming